



PHINMA EDUCATION
HUMANITY. KNOWLEDGE. INNOVATION.

Student Activity Sheet (SAS)

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Course Name: IT Business Solutions

Module Number: 12

Topic: Iteration & Refinement

Learning Objectives

- By the end of this module, you will be able to:
1. Refine designs and solutions based on usability test findings and business input.
 2. Classify usability issues based on severity, frequency, and impact.
 3. Produce a V1 → V1.1 change log and mini re-test result.

Start of the Lesson (18 minutes)

In SAS 9, you conducted usability testing sessions and summarized user feedback. You observed confusion, hesitation, mistakes, and success. That means one important thing:

- Your system is not wrong
- Your system is not finished.

In real IT projects, teams don't panic when users struggle. They iterate. Iteration means:
Build → Test → Learn → Improve → Repeat

Today, you step into the role of a real product team running its first improvement cycle. Before you begin, refresh your memory.

1. What is the difference between an observation and an interpretation?

The difference between an observation & interpretation is that observation is all about paying attention while interpretation is making assumptions, opinions.

2. Write one example of a Must-Change Issue from usability testing.

Inconsistent UI

3. What does MVP thinking say about building "perfect" systems?

MVP is not about building perfect systems, it's about including what the users need, not a complete system.

4. Give one example of a business rule/constraint that could limit a usability fix (e.g., audit trail, verified identity, pricing/hosting constraint)

Pricing/hosting constraint because even if the system is understandable for users & not hard for users, pricing constraint can limit users' needs if they need to

Main Task (70 minutes)



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purchase from the system itself.



September 24, 2026 Ugay, Gabriel Z.

Example: After submitting a payment, no confirmation message appears. The student is unsure if the payment went through and refreshes or attempts to pay again. The task is completed, but the experience causes confusion and anxiety.

3. **Enhancement Ideas.** Nice-to-have improvements.
Example: The course registration page works correctly, but adding a progress indicator (e.g., Step 1 of 3) would help students better understand where they are in the process. The task can be completed without it, but the feature would improve clarity and experience.

Rule: Fix Blockers first. Always.

Quick Check: If a screen looks ugly but the user can finish the task, is that a blocker? Why or why not?

It can be sometimes because even if a user accomplished the task, doesn't mean every user

Industry Reminder: A rare issue can be highly severe (e.g., data loss), and a frequent issue can be minor (e.g., cosmetic spacing). Prioritize based on impact, not frequency alone.

Part B. Severity vs Frequency

Professionals ask two questions:

Severity: How bad is the problem?

Frequency: How often did it happen?

Severity	Frequency	Priority
High	High	Must fix now
High	Low	Fix soon
Low	High	Fix if time
Low	Low	Nice-to-have

will accomplish effortlessly.

Example:

Problem: Users cannot find "Submit" button

Severity: High

Frequency: 4 out of 5 users

☒ Must fix now

Quick Check: If your sample size is small, which issue should you be cautious not to ignore: (A) high severity/low frequency or (B) low severity/high frequency? Why?

Answer: high severity/low frequency because one major mistake can significantly affect the system.

Part C: Prioritization (Severity × Frequency × Effort)

You already used severity + frequency in SAS 9. Now we add a third reality: effort.

Quick Scoring: For each issue, score:

1. Severity (0-4): how badly it harms usability
2. Frequency (1-3): how often it happens
1 = rare, 2 = sometimes, 3 = many users
3. Effort (1-3): how hard it is to implement
1 = small copy/layout tweak, 2 = medium, 3 = heavy redesign



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Priority Score: (Severity + Frequency) - Effort

It's not "perfect math." It's a fast decision tool when time is limited. Use this score only to start discussion; do not ignore any severity 4 blocker—slice it

Reflection: If an issue is severity 4 but effort 3, what is a smart iteration move (instead of giving up)?

- ☐ Drop it
- ☐ Defer forever
- ☒ Slice it into a smaller MVP fix

Explanation: Because there is always a way to solve every problem regardless of the severity if we really get into it.

Part D: Business Input Matters Too

Scenario: Campus Document Request System

Your group is building a Campus Document Request System where students can request documents (Transcript, Certificate of Enrollment, etc.) and track their status. After usability testing, you found these user-driven issues:

1. Students want to see their request status clearly.
2. Students want faster submission.
3. Students want fewer form fields.

Based on this, your group proposes:

"Let's remove login and allow anonymous requests so students can submit faster."

At first glance, this seems good for users. However, during a meeting, the Registrar's Office (stakeholder) gives these inputs:

1. "Every request must be tied to a verified student ID."
2. "We need a history of who submitted each request."
3. "We must be able to audit requests if there is a dispute."

These are business constraints.

What This Means

If the team follows only user preference:

1. Anonymous requests
2. Faster submission
3. Fewer steps

But if the team ignores business rules:

1. Requests cannot be verified
2. Staff cannot trace responsibility
3. The system cannot be legally trusted

So the team iterates with balance:

1. Balanced Iteration Decision
2. Instead of removing login completely, the team decides to:
 - a. Keep login using student ID
 - b. Auto-fill student information after login
 - c. Show progress indicators to make the process feel fast

As a result:

1. Users still experience a smooth flow
2. The institution still gets traceable, auditable records

Key Takeaway:





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Good iteration does not mean: "Do everything users ask."
Good iteration means: "Improve the experience without breaking business rules and technical reality."

That is why real IT iteration always balances: **User Needs + Business Rules + Feasibility**

Quick Check: Name one non-negotiable business rule in your own project.

Workers & Employers should submit a valid resume, business permit before signing their account.

Let's Practice (30 minutes)

Now that you understand severity, frequency, and business input, you will decide which issue deserves priority and defend your decision like a real product team.

Use the scale below when rating each factor:

High = 4
Medium = 2-3
Low = 0-1

You can use the numeric equivalent if you need to total or compare scores.
You can refer to the sample below as your guide:

Selected Issue:

1. Users do not know why their form submission fails.
- 2.

Factor	Your Answer [High/Med/Low]
Severity	High
Frequency	High
Business Impact	High

Why?

- A. Several users could not proceed submitting the form.
- B. Some users tried submitting multiple times.
- C. Failed submissions mean no requests are recorded in the system.

3. Justified Solution:

We will prioritize fixing unclear error messages during form submission because this issue completely blocks users from completing their request (high severity), happens to most test participants (high frequency), and directly affects the organization since unsubmitted requests mean lost or delayed transactions (high business impact).

4. Targeted Change:



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Warm-up (15 minutes)

When learning formal iteration models, look at what you already know from your usability tests.

You already have Top 3 usability issues from SAS 9. With the same groupmates, start by listing and describing your group's most important usability issues. For each issue, predict whether it is Blocker / Friction / Enhancement before the lesson. See example below as your guide.

Issue 1: Users cannot tell if their request was successfully submitted.

What is happening? After clicking "Submit," the screen refreshes but no confirmation message appears.

Some users try to submit again because they are unsure if the action worked.

Predict the issue [Blocker / Friction / Enhancement]: Friction

Now, it's your turn:

Issue 1: Users struggle to find suitable jobs because job listings are not easy to search.

What is happening? Users took time searching for a job.

Predict the issue [Blocker / Friction / Enhancement]: Friction

Issue 2: Users struggle to understand job details because important information is unclear.

What is happening? Users asked questions about the job requirement.

Predict the issue [Blocker / Friction / Enhancement]: Blocker

Issue 3: Users struggle to complete applications because some steps are confusing.

What is happening? Users hesitated before submitting the application.

Predict the issue [Blocker / Friction / Enhancement]: Friction

Now, learn how professionals decide this systematically.

Let's Learn (25 minutes)

Iteration as a Professional Process

Iteration is not random fixing. Iteration is evidence-based improvement. A simple model you will use:

Observe → Prioritize → Change → Test Again → Document

Part A. Types of Findings

Not all findings are equal. They can be:

1. **Blocker Issues:** User cannot complete task.
Example: A student tries to submit their enrollment form, but the "Submit" button does not respond or returns a system error. The form cannot be completed, so the student is unable to enroll.
2. **Friction Issues:** User completes task but with struggle.

